

Kent Nakai

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A future world filled with robots performing human-like tasks and coexisting seamlessly with society. To achieve this, I am keen to develop adaptable, reliable robots for diverse environments—applying creativity and a broad perspective shaped through living and studying in five countries.

Education

New York University Tandon School of Engineering 2025–2027

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering (in progress)

Expected Graduation: May 2027

Bard College at Simon's Rock 2023–2025

Associate of Arts in Liberal Arts (May 2025, GPA: 3.96/4.00)

Outstanding Achievement Award 2025 – Dept. of Science, Math, and Computing (1 of 2 recipients)

Technical Skills & Experience

- Developed Rescue Robots using Fusion 360, KiCad, CNC milling, laser cutting, and 3D printing
- Proficient in programming with C, C++, Python, Java, and basic Verilog
- Led a robotics team with 20+ members for 3 years and won awards at international competitions (Korea, Netherlands, and Japan)
- Raised over \$3,500 in sponsorship funds for developing robots
- Languages: Japanese (Native), English (Fluent), Chinese (Conversational)
- Lived and studied in Japan, the United Kingdom, China, the United States, and Canada

Work / Research

Research – Bard College at Simon's Rock, Massachusetts, USA

Dec 2024 – August 2025

Designed and implemented novel computer vision models and deep neural networks for low-power controllers to detect reflective spheres, reducing victim detection time by 60% in rescue environments

Robotics Intern – Blue Innovation, Tokyo, Japan

Dec 2024 – Jan 2025

Developed a ROS-based motion capture system for train inspection robots, enabling real-time tracking and control of robotic movement to enhance operational safety and precision

Robotics Intern – ALSTOM, Singapore

Aug 2024

Developed a training simulation environment in Webots to train operators in controlling train inspection robots, simulating realistic robotic behavior and interface workflows

Volunteering – Translator and Judge, RoboCup Junior Japan

Mar 2019 – Jan 2024

Volunteered as an English translator and judged competitions at national and regional levels, 3 times a year

International Achievements

- **RoboCup 2023 & 2024** – Pyeongchang, South Korea & Eindhoven, Netherlands
RoboCup Junior Rescue Line U19 — 3rd Place & Community Award
- **RoboCup Junior USA Nationals 2023 & 2024 & 2025** – New Jersey, United States
Rescue Line U19 — 1st Place for three consecutive years
- **Field Hockey Japan National Cup** – Toyama, Japan
Team: Hyogo Hearts — 2nd Place
- **Masason Foundation Scholar** – 3rd Generation grant recipient
- **JCI United Nations Japanese Young World SDGs Tour Ambassador 2019**